etc. must have been the work of conspiracy between anti-Mujib Bangladesh bureaucrats and army officers in the UK with the Pakistan government. The few reports we have indicate the actual coup was conducted by the younger army officers. Senior officers, particularly General Wasiuddin, the Bangladesh Ambassador in Kuwait, may be involved but it is extremely unlikely that they were the brains behind the plot. At best, the General could play the role of a spinola. It doesn't seem likely that US interests were necessarily involved in these developments. In the absence of hard evidence, it would be unwise to distribute responsibility over too wide an area. At the same time, we should take full notice of the fact that the Nepalese charge d'affaires in Dhaka is proPakistani. He could have played a crucial role from the communication angle. Since neither Pakistan nor China was physically present in Dhaka, we should also avoid jumping to conclusions about actual physical interference by their agencies in Bangladesh. There is all the difference in the world between sympathy and actual conspiracy.

What perplexed the spies though, was the timing: 15 August was chosen primarily to coincide with India's Independence when the establishment could be caught off guard because of the celebration. Some argued that the day had been chosen because it was a Friday and Muslim sentiments could be exploited. The return to Dhaka from London of a crucial but anonymous figure on 12 August was also a matter of speculation: was the coup plot decided abroad with Pakistan at least being privy to it?

The MEA believed that India should not panic and the government must return to 'business as usual.' It said in a note: